

26VECV03745 26VECV03745

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: NWI

Hearing date: 2026-09-23

Source URL: https://www.lacourt.ca.gov/tentativeRulingNet/ui/main.aspx?casetype=civil&dept_date=NW%20%2CNWI%2C09%2F23%2F2026

Source SHA-256: 67cea232d001e26fe805212b5919f3ac05b735441b8f4c09af1fae7904df3996

Case Number: 26VECV03745 Hearing Date: September 23, 2026 Dept: NWI

26VECV03745 Consumer Justice Law

Firm PLC v. Alexandra Bretz, et al.

September 23, 2026, at 8:30 a.m.

Van Nuys Courthouse East, Dept. I

Applications to be Admitted Pro Hac

Vice

I.

Background

Plaintiff Consumer Justice Law Firm PLC represented

Defendant Alexandra Bretz in a prior action against Defendant LexisNexis Risk

Solutions Inc. ("Prior Action") pursuant to a written retainer agreement. Plaintiff withdrew from representation in the prior action and gave notice to both Defendants of its lien against any

settlement, judgment or recovery in the Prior Action. Plaintiff alleges Defendants reached a

settlement in the Prior Action and Defendant Lexis Nexis Risk Solutions, Inc.

paid the settlement proceeds to Defendant Brez without honoring Plaintiff's lien rights.

On June 24, 2026, Plaintiff filed a complaint against

Defendants alleging (1) declaratory relief; (2) quantum meruit; (3) breach of written contract; (4) money had and received; (5) conversion; (6) constructive trust/equitable lien; (7) accounting; (8) intentional interference with prospective economic advantage; (9) intentional interference with contractual relations; (10) common counts.

On August 25, 2026, Defendant LexisNexis filed a Verified Application for Admission for Pro Hac Vice of Attorney Katherine Donald and a Verified Application for Admission for Pro Hac Vice of Attorney Derin B. Dickerson. As of September 19, 2026, no oppositions have been filed.

II. Discussion

An attorney

in good standing in another jurisdiction may apply to appear as counsel pro hac vice in the State of California by filing a verified application together with proof of service by mail of a copy of the application and notice of hearing on all parties who have appeared in the case and on the State Bar of California at its San Francisco office, with payment of the appropriate fee. (Cal. Rules of Court, Rule 9.40, subds. (c)(1), (e).) The attorney cannot be a resident of California, employed in the state, or regularly engage in substantial business, professional, or other activities in the state. (Cal. Rules of Court, Rule 9.40, subd. (a)(1)-(3).)

The written

application must state: (1) the applicant's residence and office address; (2) the courts to which the applicant has been admitted to practice and the dates of admission; (3) that the applicant is a member in good standing in those courts; (4) that the applicant is not currently suspended or disbarred in any court; (5) the title of each court and cause in which the applicant has filed an application to appear as counsel pro hac vice in this state in the preceding two years, the date of each application, and whether or not it was granted; and (6) the name, address, and telephone number of the active member of the State Bar of California who is attorney of record in the local action. (Cal. Rules of Court, Rule 9.40, subd. (d)(1)-(6).)

Katherine Donald Application

Counsel

Katherine Donald's application is made on the grounds that Applicant is a member of the Georgia bar and meets the conditions for admission in this case as counsel pro hac vice.

Applicant

has been admitted to practice in the State of Georgia (2021-present). (Application, Donald Decl., ¶2.) Furthermore, Applicant declares she is in good standing with Texas courts and not currently suspended or disbarred from appearing in any court. (Id., ¶3.) Moreover, Applicant provides her residential and office addresses. (Id., ¶7.) Applicant also states that she has not previously applied for permission to appear pro hac vice in California within the last two years. (Id., ¶5.) Likewise, Applicant provides the address for Meghan McBerry of Alston & Bird LLP, 55 Second Street, Suite 2100, San Francisco, CA 94105, who is the active California State Bar member and counsel of record in this case. (Id. at ¶8.) Additionally, the proof of service attached to the application and declaration indicates that all interested parties and the California State Bar in San Francisco were provided notice. (See Application POS at p. 5; Motion, McBerry Dec., ¶¶4-5.) Finally, McBerry declares that she paid the appropriate fee to the California State Bar for this application. (McBerry Dec., ¶4, Ex. A.)

Derrin B. Dickerson Application

Counsel

Derrin B. Dickerson's application is made on the grounds that Applicant is a member of the Georgia bar and meets the conditions for admission in this case as counsel pro hac vice.

Applicant

has been admitted to practice in the State of Georgia (2003-present). (Application, Dickerson Decl., ¶2.) Furthermore, Applicant declares he is in good standing with Texas courts and not currently suspended or disbarred from appearing in any court. (Id., ¶3.) Moreover, Applicant provides his residential and office addresses. (Id., ¶7.) Applicant also states that he has previously applied and been granted permission to appear pro hac vice in California within the last two years. (Id., ¶5.) Likewise, Applicant provides the address for Meghan McBerry of Alston & Bird LLP, 55 Second Street, Suite 2100, San Francisco, CA 94105, who is the active California State Bar member and counsel of record in this case. (Id. at ¶8.) Additionally, the proof of service attached to the application and declaration indicates that all interested parties and the California State Bar in San Francisco were provided notice. (See Application POS at p. 5; Motion, McBerry Dec., ¶¶4-5.) Finally, McBerry declares that she paid the appropriate fee to the California State Bar for this application. (McBerry Dec., ¶4, Ex. A.)

Therefore,

the Court finds that the application complies
with the requirements of California Rules of Court, Rule 9.40,
subdivision (d).

III. Conclusion

Accordingly,
Counsel Katherine
Donald's Application to be
admitted pro hac vice is GRANTED.

Accordingly,
Counsel Derin B.
Dickerson's Application to be
admitted pro hac vice is GRANTED.

Counsel McBerry
to give notice.